

Arman Jahangiri Observation

Observer: Clare Minnerath

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I observed Arman as their TA mentor during Arman's first quarter teaching at the University of Washington. Arman was leading a worksheet section on limits and derivatives. The observation began about 25 minutes into a 120 minute section where there were about 25 students in attendance. Arman was working through worksheet questions at the board with class participation.

Strengths

1. *Organization and Clarity*

The graph from the worksheet was very neatly drawn on the board, Arman's voice was clear, and at the end of each part Arman asked if there were questions. When students did have questions Arman repeated them and clarified that they heard the question correctly.

2. *Confidence and Calm Demeanor*

At one point Arman made a mistake in their work at the board. When a student pointed it out, Arman admitted to the mistake, clarified to the class why they made it, and thanked the student for pointing it out.

3. *Approachability*

A student gave an incomplete answer. Arman validated the student's partial answer as correct and guided the class to the complete answer.

Suggestions

1. Incorporating more group work or student discussion time.
2. Eliciting more student participation by asking leading questions or "Think, Pair, Share" exercises.

Overall, Arman appeared confident and experienced at the board. Arman was eager to implement the suggestions, and we continued discussion on how to best make the changes without isolating students less comfortable participating.